



Insects



Types of insects



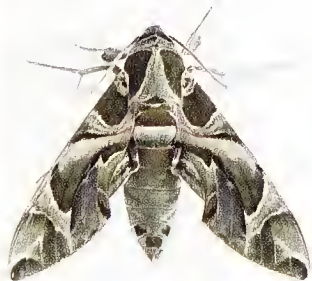
Damselflies are expert fliers and dart through the air.



Beetles have hard wing cases to protect their delicate wings.



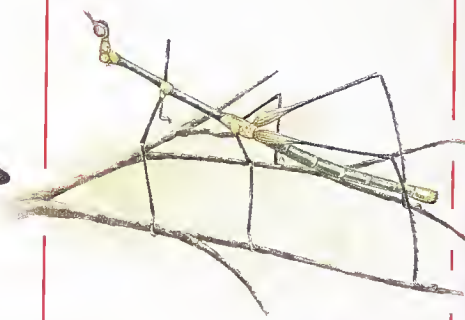
Flies have two wings that beat so fast they buzz.



Butterflies and moths have four patterned wings.

They crawl, fly, buzz, and sting – insects may be small, but there are over a million kinds, more than any other animal in the world.

Did you know?
The South American grasshopper disguises itself as a thin twig.



Tiny claws can hang on to plants.

Wasp

All insects have three sections to their bodies and six legs – just like this wasp.

The head is the first part of the body.

The thorax is the middle part of the body.

The abdomen is the end part of the body.

The six legs bend at the joints.

Wings

Ant colonies

Ants live in groups called colonies and share all the work to be done.

Growing up

Many insects change shape as they grow. This is called metamorphosis.

Ladybug egg



Larva

1 A wormlike larva hatches from an egg. It feeds and grows.



Pupa

2 The fully grown larva makes a hard case called a pupa around itself.



3 About a week later, the pupa splits open, and an adult ladybug crawls out.



Ladybug

Find out more



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